



Figure 3.3.1 - Final model

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MOVING THROUGH PERSPECTIVES
Saskia Steineke

INTRODUCTION

This chapter presents a design process that explores how space can be understood and represented and experienced through the combination of perspective and movement. Instead of relying on a single viewpoint, the work investigates how layering different ways of seeing, such as top, side, front and oblique views, can reveal a more dynamic understanding of spatial relationships. The research begins with the analysis of existing drawings that challenge conventional representation. Projects such as *Maison de plaisance de l'Empereur de la Chine*, *Following the Fish* and contemporary works like *Dessins sur la ville* demonstrate how multiple perspectives can be combined into a single image. Separately, the method of activity mapping is explored as a way to visualize movement over time. By layering actions into one image, this approach shows the temporal dimension of space and makes patterns of use readable. The final model, *Moving Through Perspectives*, brings these ideas together. It combines multiple viewpoints with the traced movement.

MAISON DE PLAISANCE DE L'EMPEREUR DE LA CHINE

Maison de plaisance de l'Empereur de la Chine is a copperplate engraving made by Georges-Louis Le Rouge around 1785, as part of his publication *Jardins Anglo-Chinois à la Mode*. The print reflects an European interpretation of Chinese imperial gardens, likely based on earlier drawings. It connects to a longer process of image translation, where original woodblock prints of the Qing dynasty gardens, created by artists like Shen Yu and Zhu Gui, were later redrawn and reproduced in Europe, becoming an important way of imagining and understanding Chinese spaces in the 18th century (Spatial Generation, Duck Dwelling Line And Location Management Of Printmaking, 2025).

The drawing shows a palace complex set within a mountainous landscape. What makes the image especially interesting is how space is constructed through multiple perspectives. Instead of using a single viewpoint, the engraving combines top views, side views, frontal views, and oblique projections. These different ways of seeing are layered on top of each other, allowing the viewer to understand the layout, elevation, and spatial relationships all at once. This creates a complex representation of space, where movement is not only depicted but also required from the viewer: to read the buildings correctly, one has to physically turn the drawing so that elements do not appear upside down or rotated. In this way, multiple viewpoints are not just shown but activated, as the viewer's shifting orientation mirrors movement through the landscape.

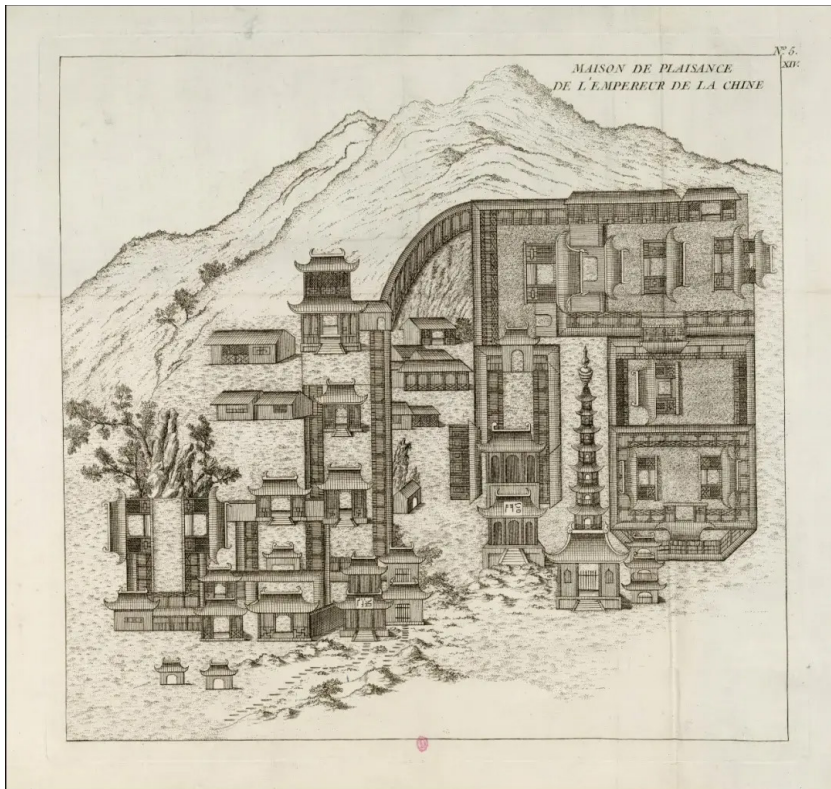


Figure 3.3.2 Maison de plaisance de l'Empereur de la Chine (Spatial Generation, Duck Dwelling Line And Location Management Of Printmaking, 2025)

Artist: Georges-Louis Le Rouge

Year: 1785

Dimensions: 28 cm x 41 cm

Material: Copperplate engraving

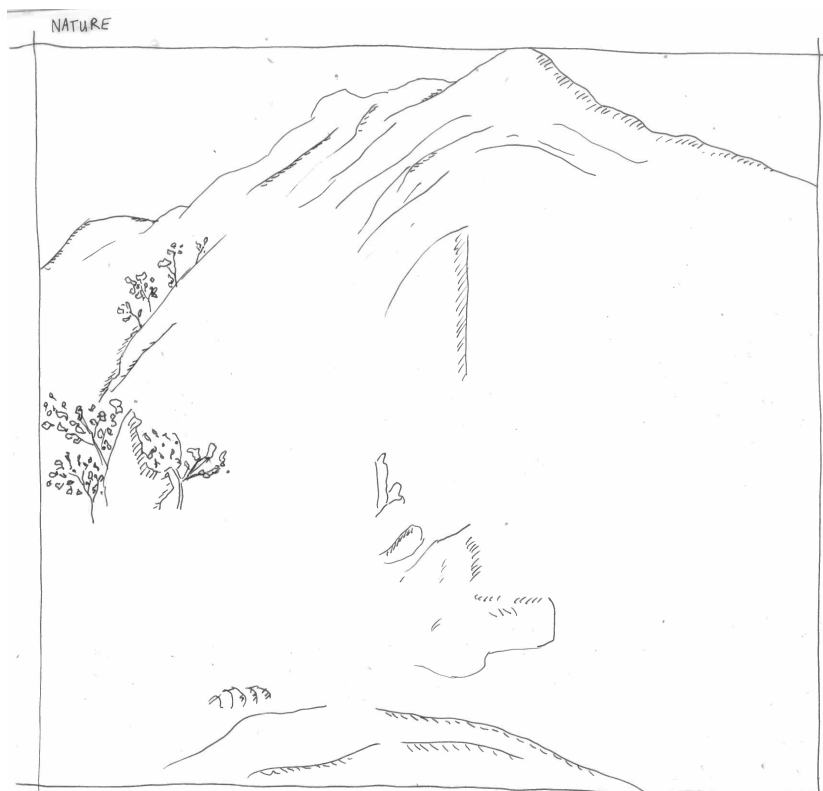


Figure 3.3.3 - Nature

Nature

The mountain in the background is drawn with shading and depth, making it feel far away. This gives the building a dramatic natural setting and helps place it in space.

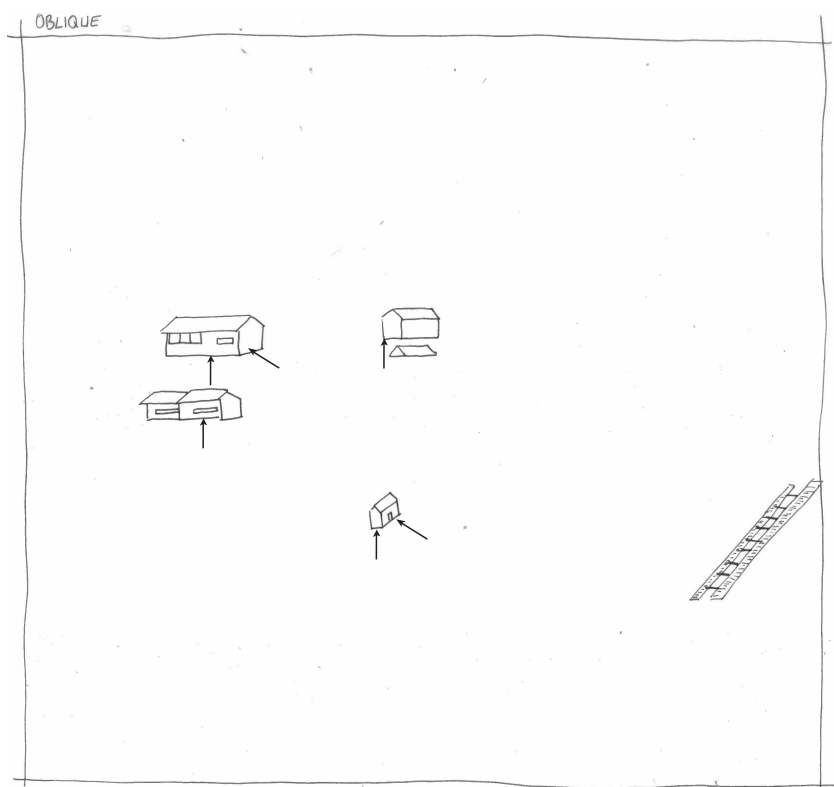


Figure 3.3.4 - Oblique

Oblique view

Some buildings and a staircase are drawn at an angle, giving them a sense of volume. This view suggests three- dimensional form. The arrows show the view points. Some building sides are distorted in oblique direction and others are orthogonal.

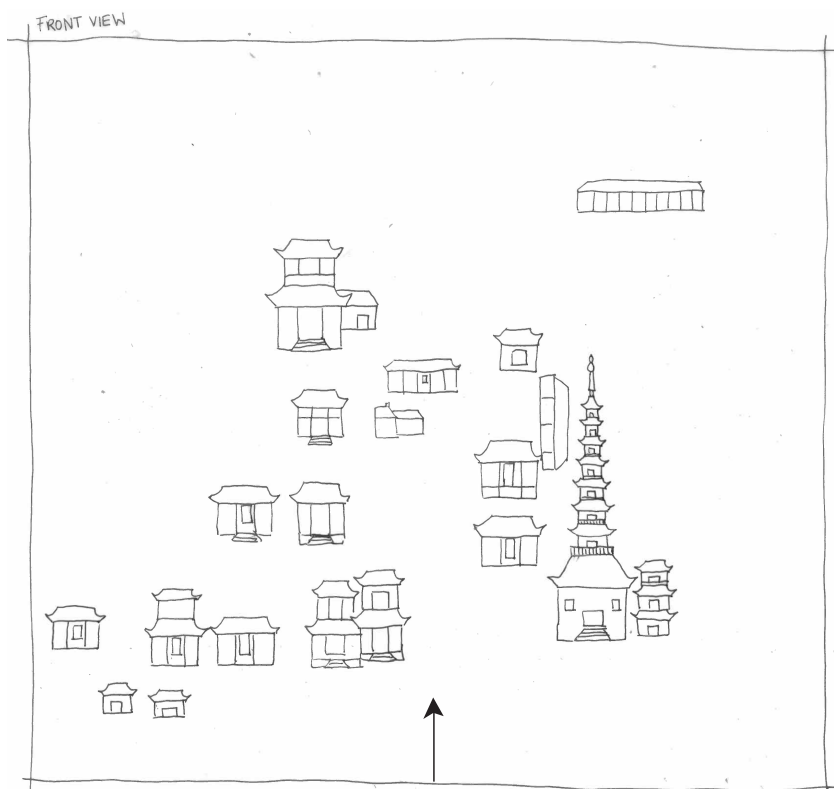


Figure 3.3.5 - Front view

Front view

The façades, pagoda towers and roof shapes are shown from the front. This straight forward view doesn't have any distortions and flattens the buildings.

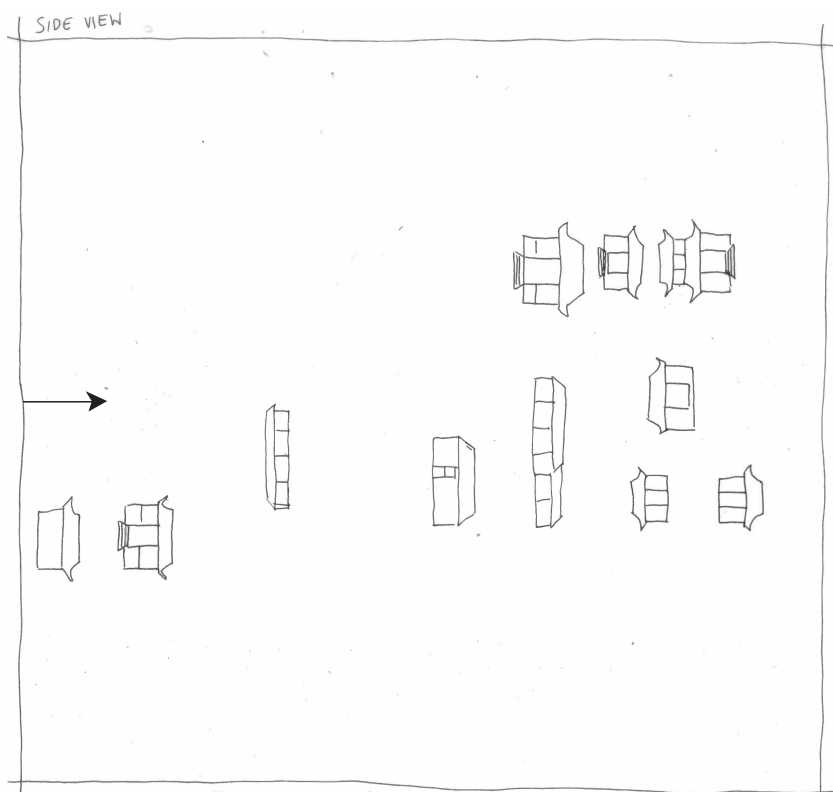


Figure 3.3.6 - Side view

Side view

Some buildings are turned 90 degrees, showing their sides like a profile. This viewpoint represents the shape and arrangement of the buildings in space, making the drawing feel more spacious without showing depth. It also invites the viewer to adjust their orientation, encouraging movement in order to perceive the buildings in an upright position.

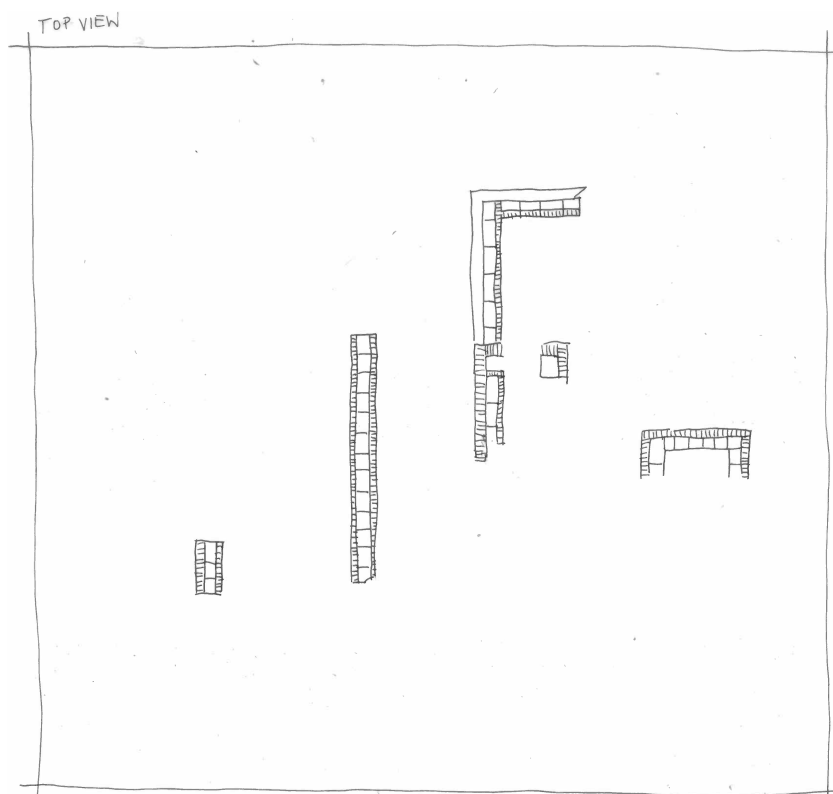


Figure 3.3.7 - Top down view

Top down view

Some buildings are shown from above, highlighting their roofs and overall layout. This viewpoint gives a clear sense of how the structures are arranged in space.

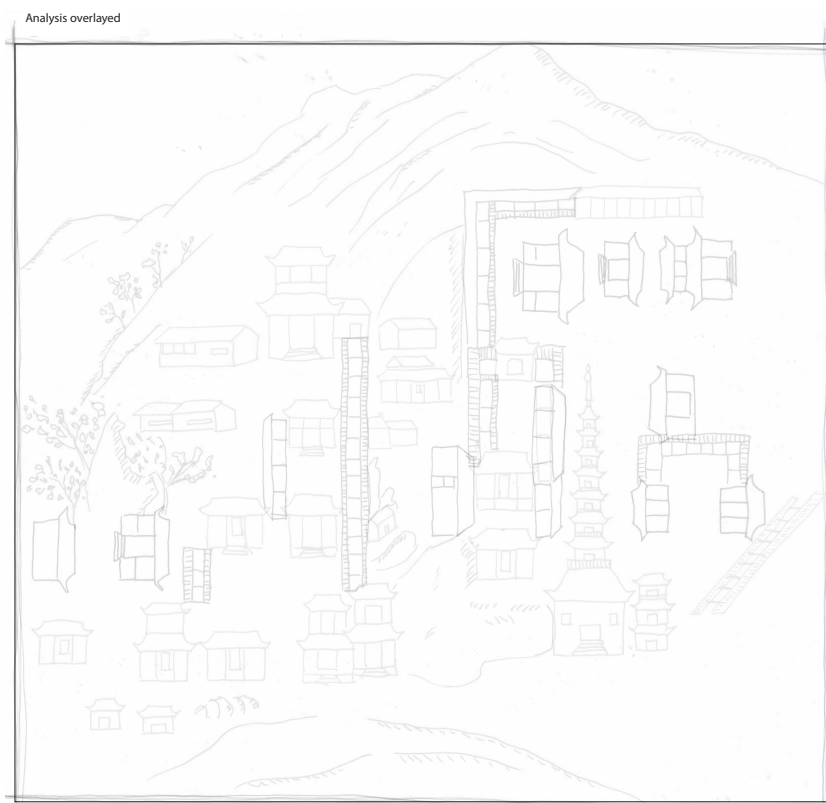


Figure 3.3.8 - Perspectives overlayed

Perspectives overlayed

All the different views, landscape, oblique, front, side, and top, are layered together in the drawing. This creates a single image that shows the buildings, its surroundings and its spatial arrangement from multiple viewpoints at once, making the scene feel more complex and spacious.

FOLLOWING THE FISH

The drawing “Following the Fish” was published in the article “Co-presences and Learning: From Interiors to the City and Back”, in a “Practice Oriented Perspective” by Paola Briata and Gennaro Postiglione in 2025.

The article describes a long term collaboration between researchers in urban planning and interior design. They studied how people from different cultural backgrounds share spaces in cities by observing everyday life. The article suggests that by understanding how people actually use spaces daily, designers can create environments that are more inclusive and flexible for everyone (Briata & Postiglione, 2025).

The drawing, following the fish, presents a building, revealing two interior rooms alongside the activities taking place on the street. By combining layered perspectives, including a frontal elevation, a top down view, and an oblique spatial logic, the drawing shows multiple everyday activities while maintaining clarity of space. Inside is represented on the facade of the building, allowing the viewer to see interior life, while the area below the facade depicts the outside, further suggested by a street and trees. Outside, people sit at tables, one person repairs a bicycle and another pets a dog. Inside, a person folds a sheet, others move along the staircase, and someone arranges cupboards. The drawing emphasizes the relationship between interior life and public space.



Figure 3.3.9 - Following the Fish (Briata & Postiglione, 2025)

Artists: Ceebu Jen di Sophie Heuser, Alba Britez Córdoba, Hoi Mun Yee

Year: 2025

Dimensions: 17,7cm x 25cm

Material: Digital drawing

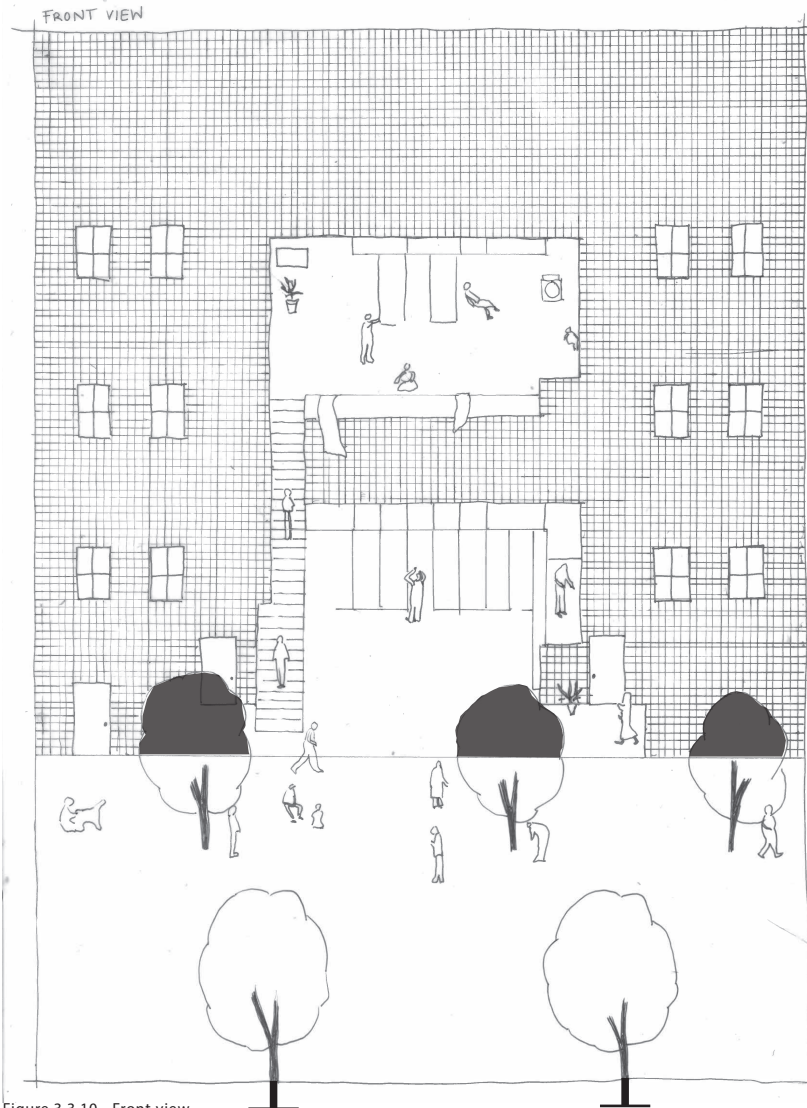


Figure 3.3.10 - Front view

Frontal view

Elements such as the façade, people, stairs and closets are shown from the front, showing the shapes and positions. This view focusses on elevation and detail, but also communicates depth through overlap, which can for example be seen in the trees overlapping over the facade of the building and by trees crossing over the frame.

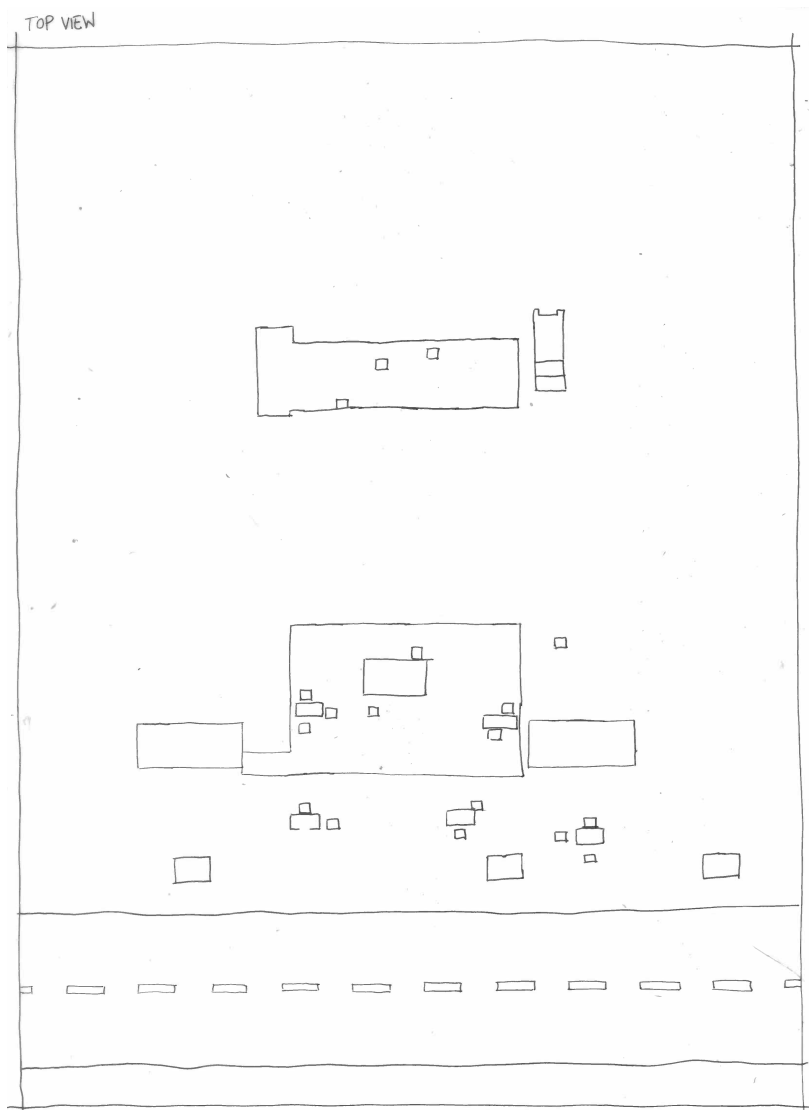


Figure 3.3.11 - Top view

Top down view

The street and floor areas are represented from above, allowing the layout of space to be understood. This view conveys depth and spatial relationships without relying on perspective distortion.

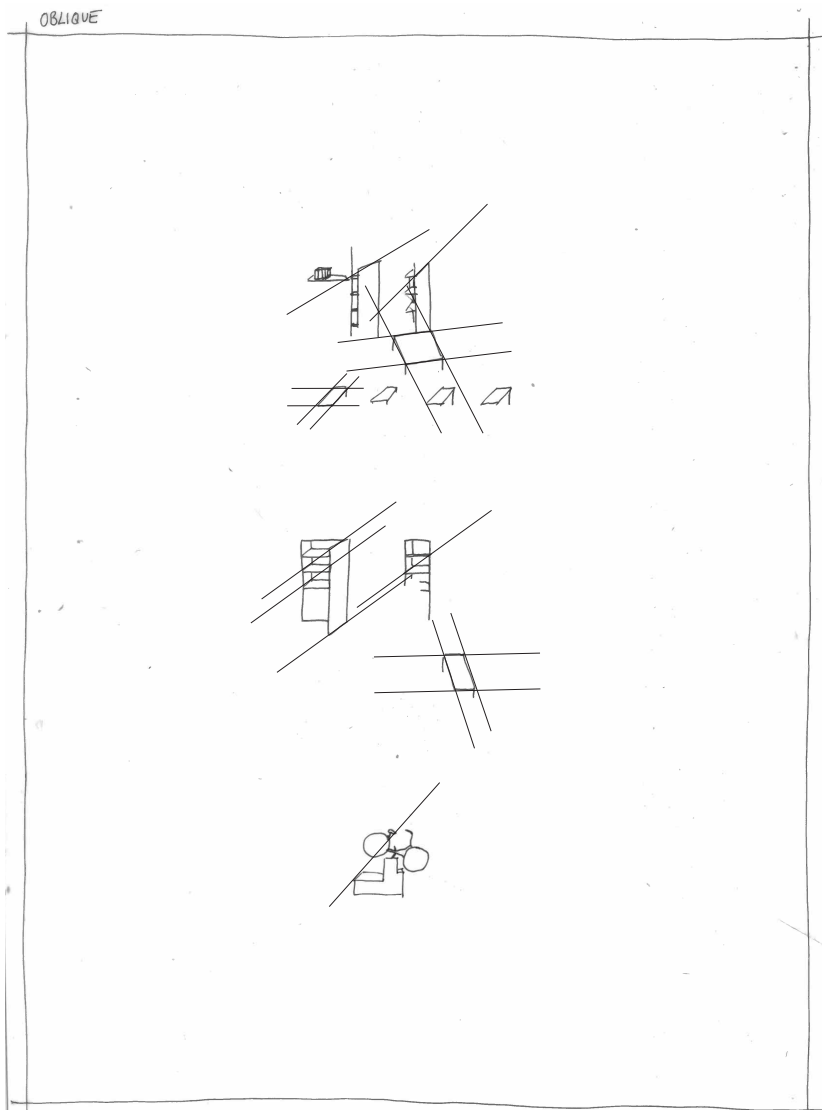


Figure 3.3.12 - Oblique view

Oblique view

Smaller, mostly interior elements appear to be drawn using an oblique system, although it is difficult to read clearly due to their small scale, where the front faces are shown in full scale and depth recedes at an angle without converging lines. This suggests three-dimensionality without the distortion of realistic perspective, which would otherwise cause elements to diminish in size and converge toward vanishing points.

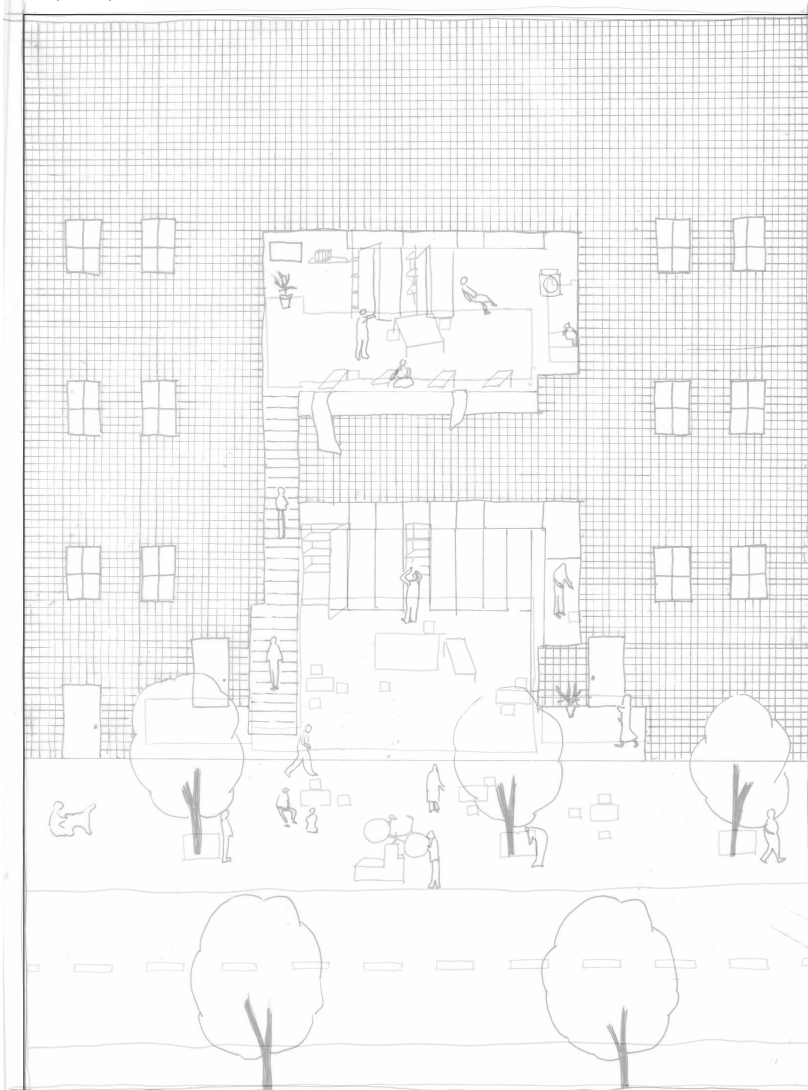


Figure 3.3.13 - Perspectives overlayed

Perspectives overlayed

All the layers, the frontal view of the façade and people, the top down street in front of the building and the oblique view of interior elements are layered on top of each other. Together, they create a single image that shows the building, the street and the activities inside and outside all at once.

DESSINS SUR LA VILLE - SOUS SOL

Dessins sur la ville (Drawings on the City) by Clément Masurier is a detailed graphic work that explores the complexity of urban life by revealing its hidden layers. Created as part of a larger series developed after his time in Rome in 2015, the drawing reflects Masurier's critical view of the modern city as something both real and illusory shaped by constant growth and human movement (The Drawings On The City By Clément Masurier, z.d.).

The composition is structured into three horizontal layers, each representing a different level of the city. The upper layer shows the visible surface: people walking across streets and public spaces, with elements like crosswalks and stairs suggesting transitions between urban zones. This part feels open and light. In contrast, the middle layer is dark and dense, showing underground tunnels. Through circular openings, we see trains, metro platforms and crowds waiting, revealing the hidden infrastructure that keeps the city moving. The lowest layer presents a large interior space, like a station hall, where small human figures, which keep the same size in all three parts of the drawings, move in different directions.

Masurier uses fine linework and strong contrasts between light and dark to guide the viewer's eye across these layers. By combining top views with frontal views, the drawing merges different ways of seeing into a single image, allowing multiple spatial experiences to exist at once.

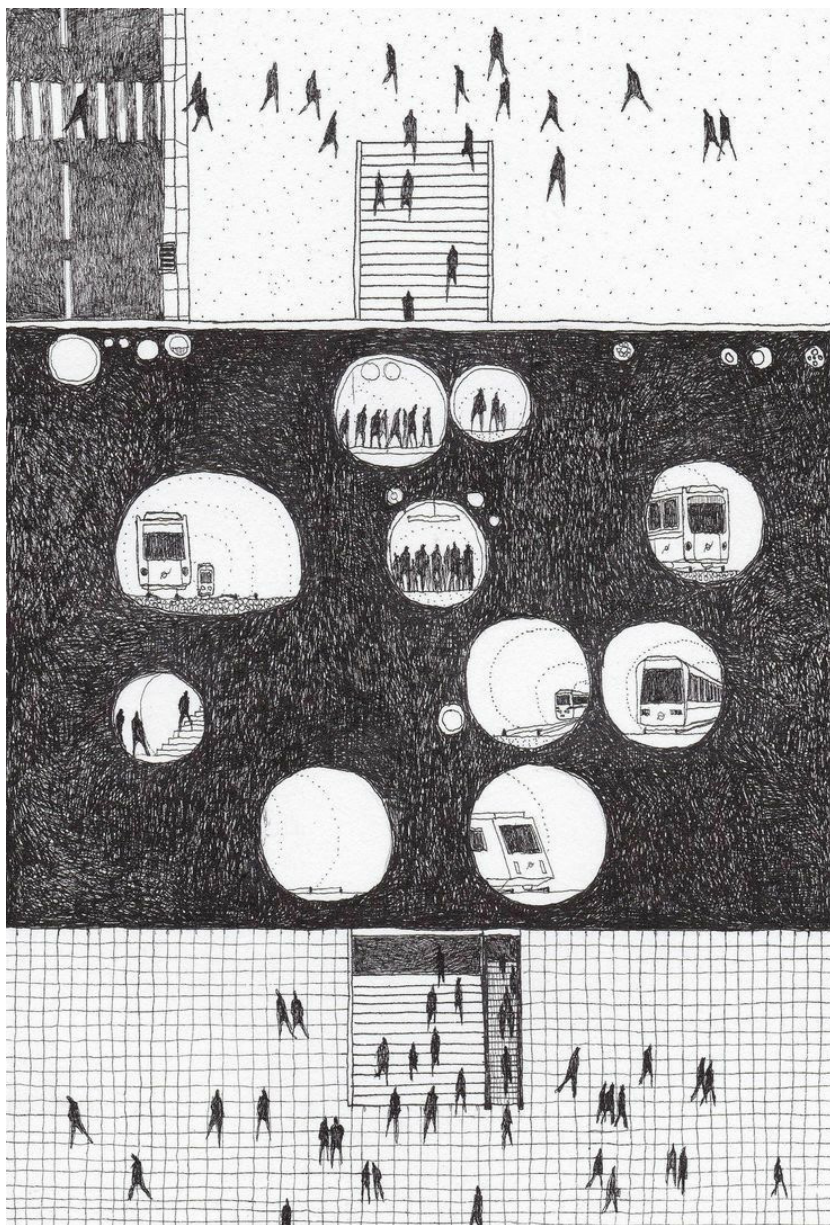


Figure 3.3.14 - Dessins sur la ville - Sous Sol (Chapitre Un - Clément Masurier, z.d.)

Artists: Clément Masurier

Year: 2015

Dimensions: -

Material: Graphic work

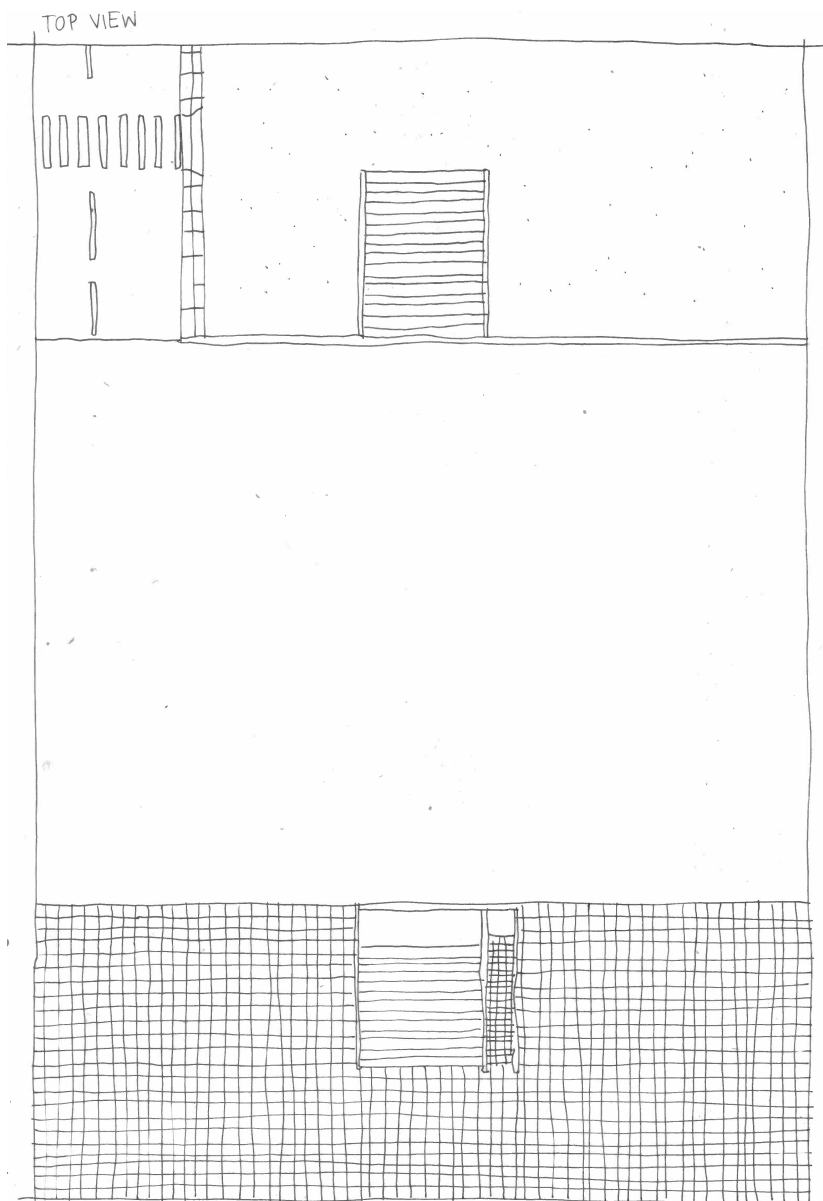


Figure 3.3.15 - Top view

Top down view

From above, we see the streets surface as an layout with a crosswalk, stairs and the station hall. This perspective makes the urban life appear orderly and schematic.

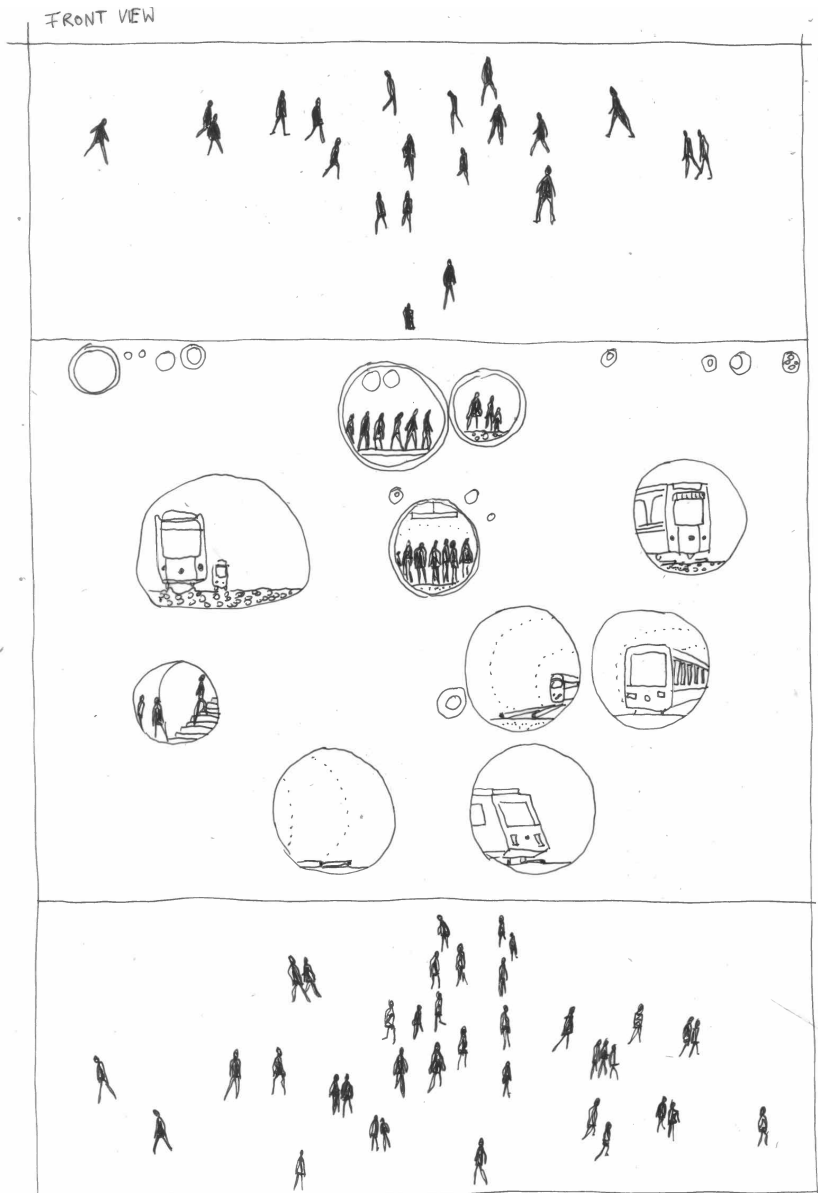


Figure 3.3.16 - Front view

Front view

With the front view, the drawing reveals a section through the metro station, where trains move and people wait along platforms. This view adds depth and human presence, showing the constant flow of urban life beneath the surface.

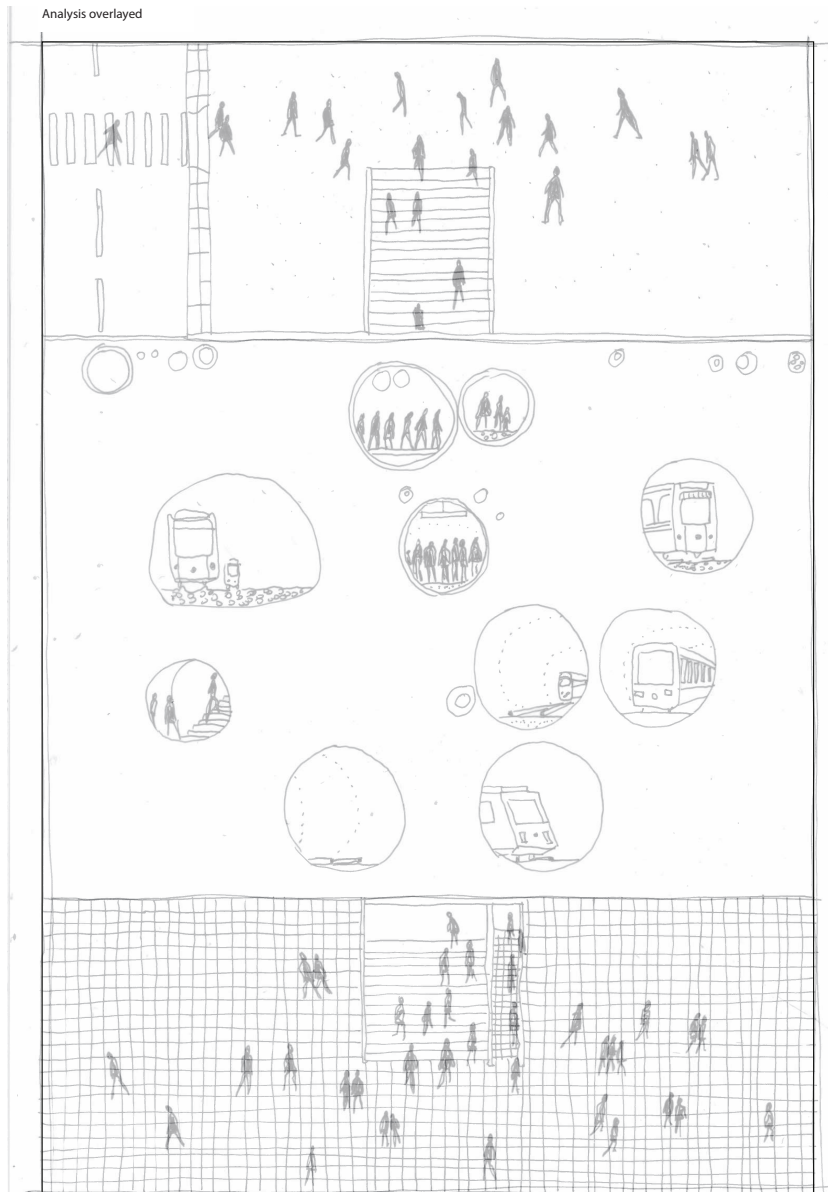


Figure 3.3.17 - Perspectives overlayed

Perspectives overlayed

By combining top down and frontal views, the drawing layers different spatial experiences into one image. This creates a complex, almost disorienting effect that reflects the hidden interconnectedness of the city.

ACTIVITY MAPPING

Activity mapping is a method used to visualize how movement and use unfold over time within a space, revealing patterns that are not visible in a single moment. In my drawing of a desk setup, I translated this idea into six layered images, each representing a different timestamp of

activity, when overlaid, they form a composite image that traces movements in one frame. This approach relates to the concept of the “palimpsest” described by Sarah Wigglesworth and Jeremy Till in *The Disorder of the Dining Table* in 1997 (Workshop Experiment, 2023), where space is understood not as static, but as continuously reshaped by use and time. Similarly, the work of Heather Hansen demonstrates how repeated gestures can be layered into a single visual record, capturing motion as a trace and a form (Digital Synopsis, 2026). Together, this frames activity mapping as a way to document the relationship between space and time, transforming everyday actions into a readable spatial narrative.

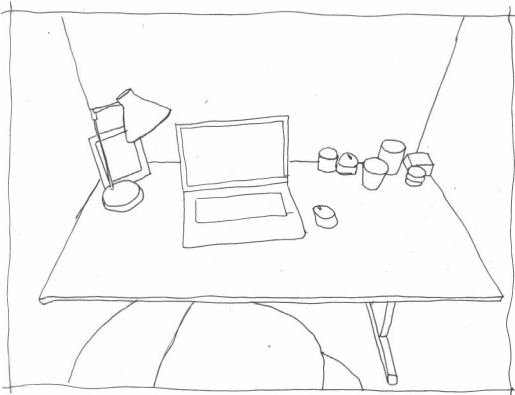


Figure 3.3.18 - Desk drawing 1

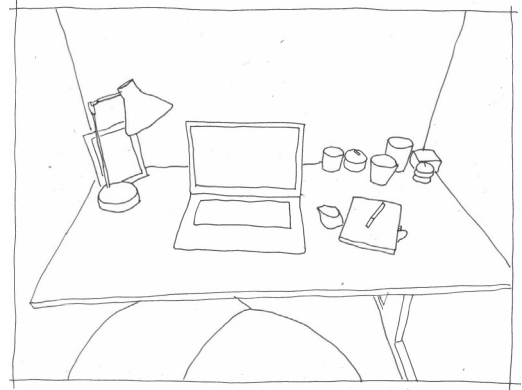


Figure 3.3.19 - Desk drawing 2

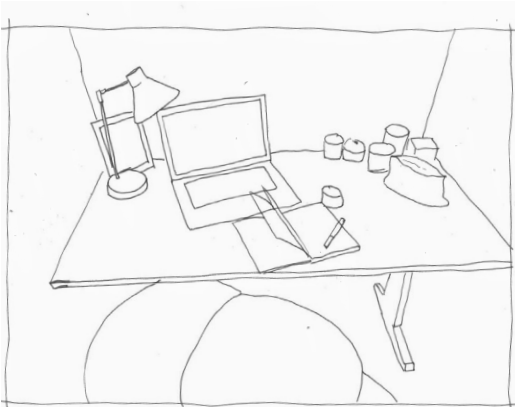


Figure 3.3.20 - Desk drawing 3

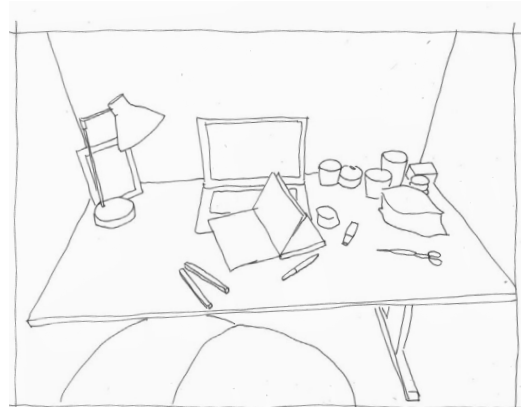


Figure 3.3.21 - Desk drawing 4

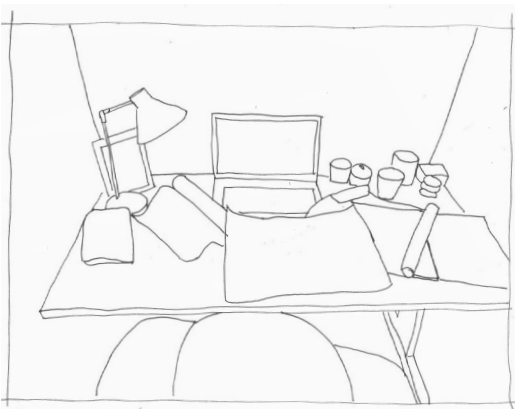


Figure 3.3.22 - Desk drawing 5

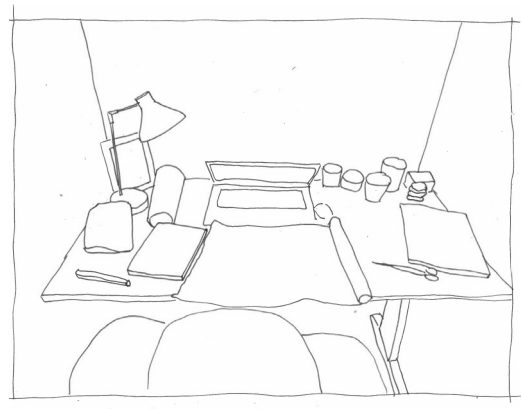


Figure 3.3.23 - Desk drawing 6

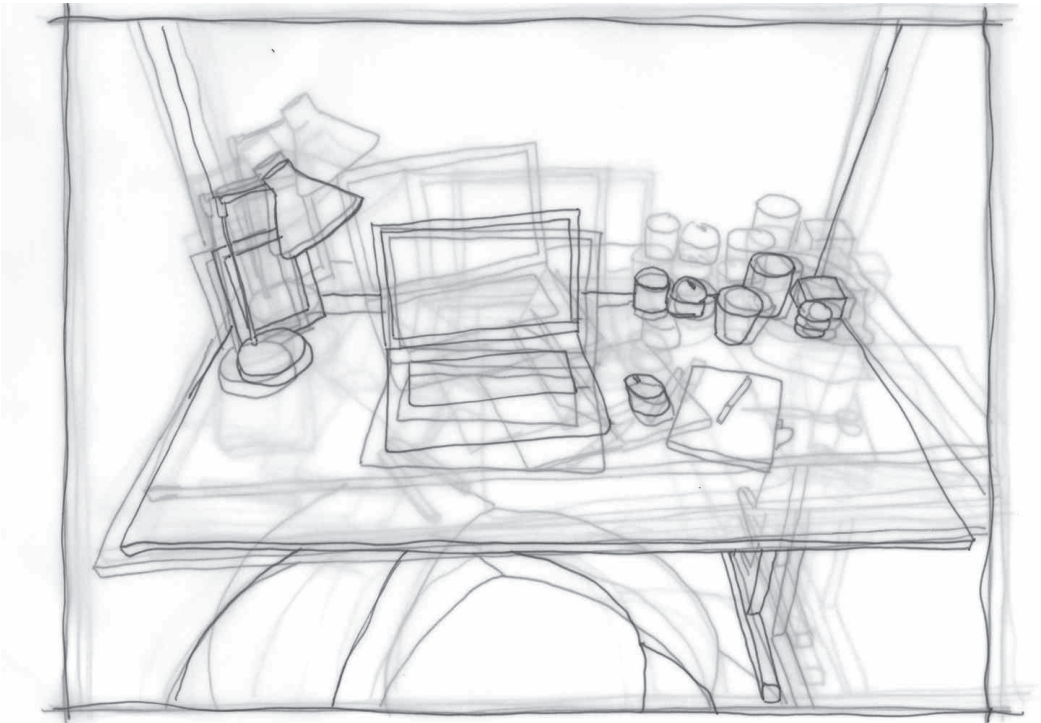


Figure 3.3.24 - Desk drawing combined

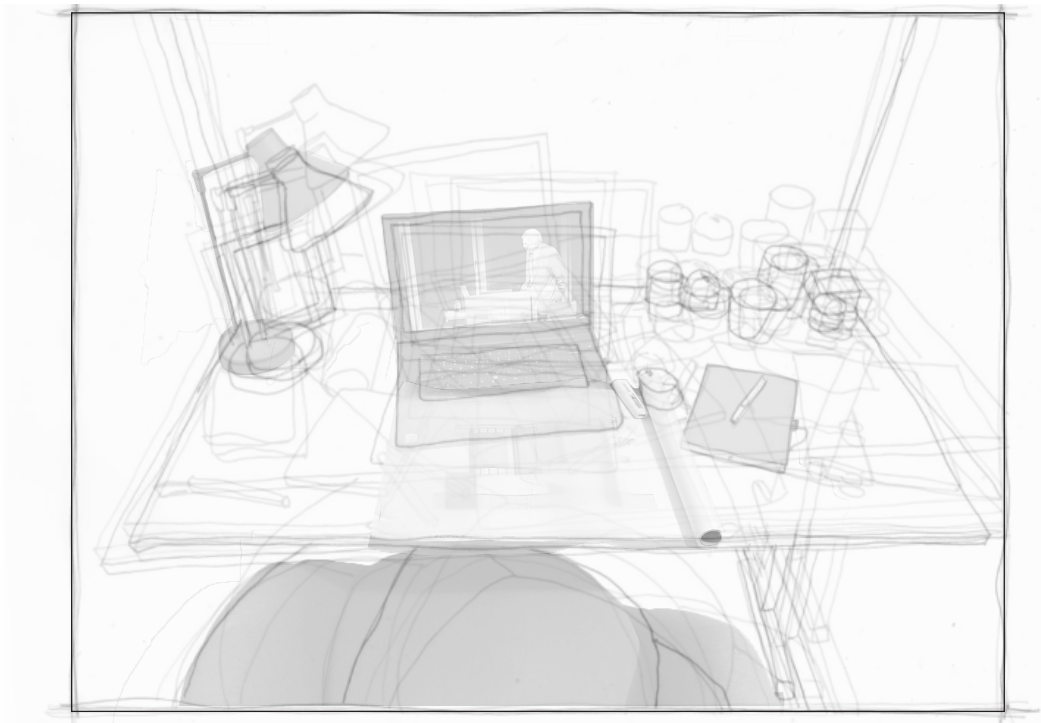


Figure 3.3.25 - Desk drawing combined with collage

FINAL MODEL: MOVING THROUGH PERSPECTIVES

This project presents a model of a house shown in an oblique view, combining both two dimensional and three dimensional elements. Some furniture is drawn directly onto the walls using different perspectives, such as front view, side view, top view and oblique view, while other pieces are physically constructed in 3D. The goal of this project is to combine these different perspectives to create a clearer understanding of space. By layering multiple viewpoints, the model helps the viewer read and interpret the spatial structure of the house in a playful way. Movement is an important aspect of the project. The path of a person moving through the house is captured within the model, drawn across the floors, walls and doors. These moments are connected by a continuous line, indicating the sequence of actions and guiding the viewer through what happens.



Figure 3.3.26 - Final model



Figure 3.3.27 - Final model 1



Figure3.3.28 - Final model 2



Figure 3.3.29 - Final model 3



Figure 3.3.30 - Final model 4

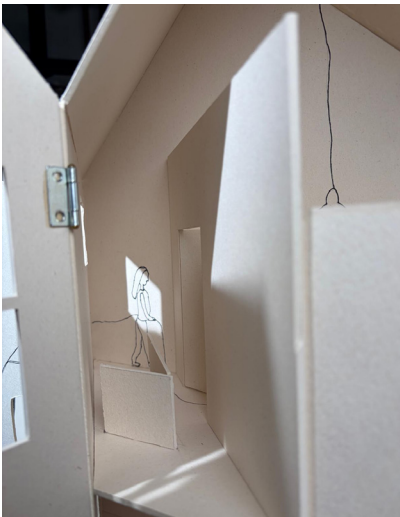


Figure 3.3.31 - Final model 5

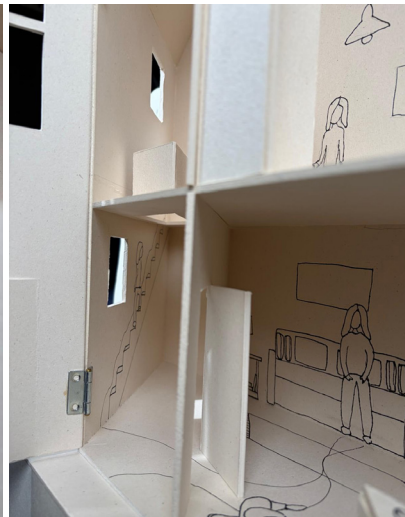


Figure3.3.32 - Final model 6

CONCLUSION

This project shows that space is flexible and experienced in different ways, shaped by perspective, movement, and time. The analysis of reference works demonstrated how layering multiple viewpoints can reveal hidden relationships within a space, while activity mapping highlighted the importance of temporal sequences in understanding how spaces are used and inhabited. The final model, *Moving Through Perspectives*, combines these insights by integrating multiple perspectives with the traced movement of a person through the house. This combination allows the viewer to read the spatial structure while following the flow of activity, making both the physical form and the lived experience of the space legible. Ultimately, the project concludes that combining perspective and movement offers a richer understanding of architectural space. It shows that space can be made visible not only through geometry, but also through sequences of use and different viewpoints.

